

Sputnik's four antennae sent information on Earth's atmosphere back to the surface.

Some satellites look like slowly moving stars.

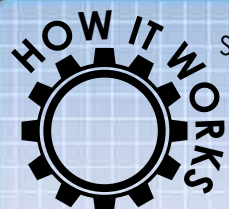
Did you know?
Laika the dog became the first animal to orbit Earth when she zoomed into space on *Sputnik 2*, a month after *Sputnik 1*.

The satellite contained a battery to power it and a radio transmitter.

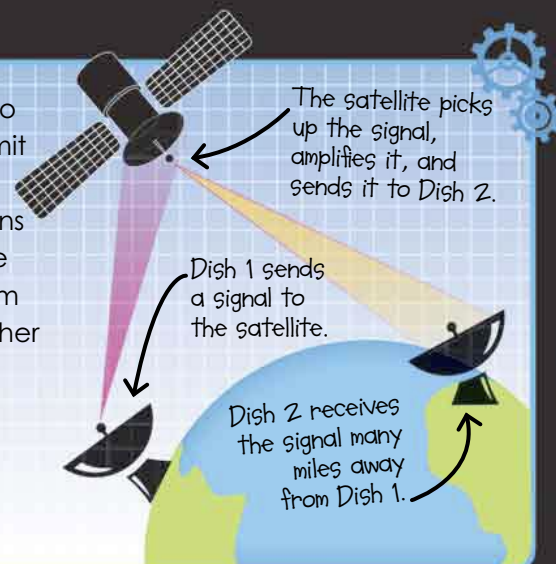
Solar panels power the majority of satellites.

Modern satellites

There are now **THOUSANDS** of artificial satellites in orbit above our heads, transmitting signals or taking pictures for use in **communication, navigation, research, and even spying**. We have also sent space probes into orbit around other bodies in our Solar System: They are now satellites of the *Moon, Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, and the Sun*.



Satellites use radio waves to transmit information. Communications satellites receive a radio signal beamed up to them from Earth and transmit it to another point on Earth's surface. In this way, a signal—such as a television broadcast—can be sent over a very long distance almost instantaneously.



How it changed
Satellites allow us to communicate instantly. They also warn us about wild weather, keep us from getting lost, and—experts believe—help keep the world at peace.

the world



The world's first programmable **COMPUTER** was the Z3, invented in 1941.



The **V-2 ROCKET** was developed by German Wernher von Braun in the 1940s.